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mz_king1 Pixel 9

...

My experience using the Google Pixel 9

It has been 2 months now that I have been using the Google pixel 9 and I'm here to share my experience.

Just to note I am a Medical student and am not a heavy user I use my phone only for my day to day tasks and education.

I previously was using the Pixel 6a. Honestly it was a great phone other than the time to time overheating that sort of annoyed me. I decided to upgrade to the Pixel 9 after watching tons of review videos and vlogs on it.

Some of the key things that I have noticed improvement in were:

1. Battery lasting
2. Refresh rate
3. Display brightness

Now here are my key takeaways,

Software-wise experience in both phones are practically the same despite Google marketing this phone with heavy AI improvements and better overall experience. Only thing I have experienced are stronger haptics.

I still now and then struggle with the fingerprint reader even though Google had advertised that they had improved the speed of the reader.

Some of the new features like the Add-me in the camera app dosen't always work out smoothly as expected. I've experimented with it several times and I've noticed that It sometimes give out a weird Blue tint on to the person that was added to the photo. Other times it dosen't even add the 2nd person.

I'm happy that they have added Mag safe for wireless charging to the phone. Although realistically I still use Wired charging as its way faster.

What I observed about this phone is that it's heavy. It's understandable considering the bigger battery. Although coming from the Pixel 6a which was really slim and light this was quite the jump for me.

Design-wise, the only unique thing I enjoyed was the island like camera visor. Everything else from the front glass to the flat rails were like a iphone to me. I literally put this phone side by side with my brothers iphone 15 and I couldn't find any difference other than the camera layout.

The screenshots app is actually one of the best things Google has created. I used it very often and it helps me alot with managing my screenshots.

Now my advices for Google,

Before the Pixel 6a, I was an iphone user. The only reason I left apple ecosystem to come to google's line was because of their software experience and its very useful features. I don't mind the whole idea that they try to copy Apples way of designing their phones like a "slab", all that matters to me is the software experience.

I am aware most users complain about hardware like "chip performance"and stuff. For an average user like myself its not highly essential, I just need to get my tasks done. Simple things like unlocking your phone,

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If Google markets or advertises a feature or something they have to make sure that it runs 99% smoothly in their beta stage before campaigning it to their broader audience.

Google has to work on their gallery app. That thing is no different from my laptop file storage system. The Google Photos have much better organization of their videos/photos as compared to the Gallery app.

Google has to work on Connectivity/Network compatibility issues. Both my previous and current pixel have connectivity problems with my home wifi. I get 3 bars on my pixel while others with their other phones get full bars. I've tested it with public networks and the same thing has happened.

These are my thoughts and advices, I'm not discrediting Google's up-to-date work from where they started. That definitely is a huge improvement. I hope atleast some of the issues I've mentioned gets sorted with the Pixel 10 or any of the upcoming android updates.

But yeah overall Pixel 9 does the job for me.

Thanks for reading this Team Pixel.



105



85

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I used to have issues with my fingerprint reader on the 9pro too, I doubted all the reviews and hype around ultrasonic whatever sensor cause it turns out to be more terrible than what I used to have on my Pixel8.

Until one day when my phone fell and the screen guard was really damaged, I changed it to a new one and I was just going to open my phone as always, I doubt if my hand touched the screen before the phone unlocked.

The fingerprint is blazing fast, I mean jet speed like fast and it's been this fast since I changed the screen guard till today.



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half by storing two versions of my thumb.

**CowOrker01** • 6mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

Seriously, this is the way.

**rxinquestion** • 6mo ago

Oh damn thanks for this. I was starting to just have the mindset of dealing with it. Now it's perfect.

**mz_king1** **OP** • 6mo ago • Edited 6mo ago

Pixel 9

I did this and it works really well when you have multiple copies. It's just when I compare it to other Android on-screen fingerprint readers they perform badly.

Like let's take Samsung Galaxy S25 for an example, it's finger print is way quicker and you don't need multiple copies of your fingerprint for it. Even if the display is turned off, the fingerprint reader area is always a hotspot. You just need to tap and it jumps into the home screen with ease.

**rslht33433** • 3mo ago

I finally upgraded to the pixel 9 from pixel 5. I miss the fingerprint sensor on the back every day. Not necessarily the location but it literally worked 99.9% of the time and it was fast and effortless.

I am maybe at 80-90% on the pixel 9 and that's with 2 sets of my primary finger (my right thumb). Although face unlock when available is nice and the ability to use my index finger to unlock the phone on the desk is also nice.

**mz_king1** **OP** • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

Do you have the touch sensitivity feature on?

**HeednGrow** • 6mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro

Yes!!

**theS3rver** • 6mo ago

if you have a screen protector glass, make sure its thinner than 0.4mm, makes all the difference!

**SlayerCR777** • 6mo ago

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**theS3rver** • 6mo ago

Mine works 95% as well with the right screen protector as without

**Prashant12skar** • 4mo ago

I'm not having any problem with fingerprint reader

**matteventu** • 6mo ago

Pixel C, 1 XL, 3, 6, 8 Pro, 9 Pro | Pixel Buds Pro Top 1% Commenter

The screenshots app is actually one of the best things Google has created. I used it very often and it helps me alot with managing my screenshots.

Fully agree with this, but it pains me to see how it seems already abandoned.

I wish they gave it a decent UI like the Nothing Essential Space as well as integrated functionality with the Pixel Recorder (which, just like Pixel Screenshots, is designed to work 100% offline), because it feels quite barebone as it is now.

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

I actually love the screenshots UI. They could make a few tweaks here and there but overall it's a decent app. I wish they could design the gallery the same way. And yeah offline work access would be amazing.

**LukaAnders** • 6mo ago

I have a pixel 8 and no clue what you're talking about. I just took a screenshot, and all it showed me were options to share, edit or translate. I also couldn't find an app named "screenshots". Am I missing something?

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

It's limited only to the Pixel 9 series that's probably why you can't see it.

**LukaAnders** • 6mo ago

I just tried to side load the apk, but sadly it doesn't work. Maybe in a future update, or in my next phone

**matteventu** • 6mo ago

Pixel C, 1 XL, 3, 6, 8 Pro, 9 Pro | Pixel Buds Pro Top 1% Commenter

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It "scans" the screenshots and tags them using on-device AI, all offline and without sending any data anywhere (for instance, as opposed to the Google Photos backup and search which are cloud-base and made possible because Google literally sees the images).

This allows you to ask Gemini stuff about things that are in your screenshots.

The good news is that an open source alternative exists:

<https://github.com/AnsahMohammad/shots-studio>

You can run it with cloud-based AI (for free, using your own personal key for the API of Gemini belonging to your Google account), or locally using Gemma (an open source AI model similar to Gemini released by Google) which you can set up all within that same app. It's very good if you're a heavy "screenshots user".



LukaAnders • 6mo ago

That's amazing, thank you so much! If there only was something like this for my gallery too 😊👀



matteventu • 6mo ago

Pixel C, 1 XL, 3, 6, 8 Pro, 9 Pro | Pixel Buds Pro 🗨️ Top 1% Commenter

Technically you can add any pictures I think 😊



SlayerCR777 • 6mo ago

This is all pretty accurate, switched from 6a to 9 as well. But I don't have network issues, not sure what's up with that for you.



mz_king1 OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

Idk lol, maybe it's just my pixel. I tried factory resetting if it fixes the issue but nope it doesn't.



LostMyTurban • 6mo ago

Just switched from a 6a to the 9 today coincidentally. So far biggest dislikes are the overall weight and the rounded corners. Feels too "soft" if that makes sense. Battery is significantly better than using the 6a with the nerf though so this was one inevitable for me. And as others have mentioned, I set mine to stop at 80% charge.

My biggest worry is the camera bump. On the 6a, it sits flush so a Spigen case has an indent in that area. Because of the bump, even with a Spigen case it's flush with the case, meaning it's more prone to scratching and cracking. I've had pixels with cracked camera covers and it's a PAIN.



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camera bump of this phone. Whenever I'm pulling out this phone, I instantly catch people glancing at my camera bump. It's something like a pixel identification marker and I love it.

Personally I don't use a bump protector since I like to see the clean "matte look" at the back.

**TheTomatoes2** • 6mo ago

9 Pro | 7 | 5a | 4a | 3 Top 1% Commenter

The default gallery app is Google Photos...

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

Google photos is the default app. Although I use the Google Gallery since it's faster to access photos that are pulled straight from your storage. Moreover it doesn't compress any photos or videos like Google Photos does.

Since the Google gallery was made by Google itself, I suggested that they work on its optimization.

**TheTomatoes2** • 6mo ago

9 Pro | 7 | 5a | 4a | 3 Top 1% Commenter

You can automatically show device files in the main Photos tab. Just turn on backup for the folders.

Google Photos does not compress files. Ensure you kept Original quality selected in the backup settings.

Gallery is a super lite version of Photos. If you want more features, use Photos.

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

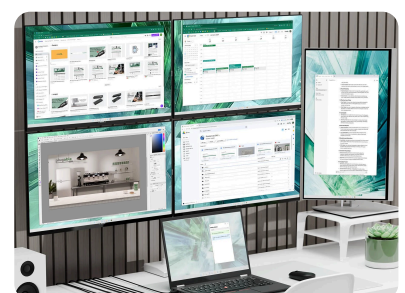
Pixel 9

I didn't know that, I had the backup thing turned off till now I just now went to the settings and toggled it on. Thanks a lot.

**mylostzebra** • 6mo ago**u/PlugableOfficial** • Promoted

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[windowscentral.com](https://www.windowscentral.com)



[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)**disputeaz** • 6mo ago

I have ditched iphone this year bc I am really not inclined to spend huge amounts of money on devices with minimal improvements. And they then rolled out Iphone16e "budget" version for the price of mid-level android phones. So I am sticking with "a" pixels for a while (not sure either I need to spend more on their flagship models)

**Ok-Implement6481** • 5mo ago

Don't fault android devices for Apple making its iPhones look more...like Androids. If those 17 air leaks are legit then you'll find it even more difficult to tell the difference between your pixel and an iPhone 🤖 not to mention the iPhone flips coming out soon after the flip 7 and Moto razr made people fall in love with flip phones again. Current iPhones remind me of the Galaxy S10 lite from like 2019.

**oPEEPINGTOMo** • 6mo ago

How much screen on time do you average before it dies?

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

Around 12-14 hours max

**Berzerker7** • 6mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

I'm sorry that's just completely impossible.

No Android phone is doing 12-14 hours SOT. Are you charging it at all during the day?

**cloud9ineteen** • 6mo ago

I get 16.5 hours screen on per full charge on my pixel 9. I charge my phone every 1.5 days and only to 80% as a result. Stat is accurate because I use accubattery. My standby time is 46 hours. The combined time is 33 hours which matches my experience of going 1.5 days before needing to charge again.

Edit: I don't watch videos or video call much. Most of my screen on time is browsing Reddit.

**Berzerker7** • 6mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

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Screenshot of battery page.



cloud9ineteen • 6mo ago

[battery stats](#)



Berzerker7 • 6mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

An estimate using a third-party app is completely inaccurate.

Give me your pixel built-in stats screen under "Battery Usage" when you get down to $\leq 5\%$ showing your SoT number in that stats page.



cloud9ineteen • 6mo ago

It's up to you whether or not to believe it. I never let my phone get down to 5%. I don't really care to prove anything to you.

Edit: I'm a paid user of accubattery and this is the fourth phone I'm using it with. I'm a strong defender of this app. It has helped me understand what's good and what's not for my phone and even before Google supported limiting charge to 80%, it allowed me to set alarms and restrict it resulting in my battery health still being over 90% after two years.



Berzerker7 • 6mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

It's not up to me lol. You're the one who makes the claim they can get 16.5 hours of SOT when the best battery life Android phones now can barely do 8-9. So you're full of shit if you can't prove it.



cloud9ineteen • 6mo ago • Edited 6mo ago

I proved it dude. I don't have to make anything up. I had an S22 before and I was getting 8 hours on it. I'm getting 16 hours on pixel 9. My wife only gets 8-9 hours on her pixel 9. You are missing the point. I'm not making the case that pixel gives everyone 16 hours screen on time. My screen on usage is pretty efficient. My wife does a lot of video calling and Instagram scrolling. I use Reddit with an app in dark mode and pretty much everything is black and white and text and I'm always on Wi-Fi.

My point is I'm happy with battery life on my phone. It works really well for my needs.

Edit: slight clarification. I'm not saying I will get 16 hours of screen on time as part of my regular usage. I'm saying I will get 16 hours off a full

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Here are the similar stats from my wife's phone.[wife's pixel 9 stats](#)



Lilliam_Pumpernickel • 6mo ago • Edited 6mo ago

Yeah that estimate is not accurate. Also hence why it's called an "estimate".

Mine shows 12h but at best I get 8-9 hours (not Pixel).

Another reason is that the 16h 40m shown doesn't account for battery used during screen off time. When people talk about SOT it refers to the number of hours of screen on time when you're using the phone in a real world scenario, so there's going to be times when the screen is off (and using up battery) as well. It's not referring to how much pure screentime you can get while lab testing the phone.



cloud9ineteen • 6mo ago

Yeah I realized that SOT is the portion of time my screen is on as part of my regular usage not the continuous screen on time I get on a full battery. I would estimate that's still about 12 hours in my case out of the 33 hours or so of overall battery life that I get. But since I don't go full charge to zero charge, it's hard to estimate the true number.



mz_king1 OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

I don't usually have the phone battery dying before I can charge again. I know I am probably ruining the battery health but I usually charge it when I am not using it. That's how I manage to keep it for that many hours. Although if I were to straight up use it without charging it would last me about 6 hours I suppose.



Berzerker7 • 6mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

Ok, yeah, so not really an accurate stat at all then.

People care about straight no-charge SOT when they ask about this.



mz_king1 OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

My bad, I didn't understand your question at the time. Well yeah it stands for about 6 hours no charge.



OzarkBeard • 6mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

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...main battery doesn't seem to be in a constant 100% state of charge.

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

I've already set it to 80%. I only drain the battery till about 10-15% and then I charge it back.

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

Yeah I charge in between

**mylostzebra** • 6mo ago**u/ITHappyStudios** • Promoted

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[View More](#)ithappystudios.com**ItsRahulll** • 6mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro

What gallery app is there for the pixel? I thought you just use Google photos as the main photo viewing app on the phone.

**RJ_Satyadev** • 6mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

Same question 🤔

**Micromize** • 6mo ago

It is just the gallery app from Google. I think that is the one he means.

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

Yeah that's the one

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)**uniquorndawg** • 6mo ago

I think you're meant to use the Google Photos app, which comes with the phone for a reason.

**Flashy_Variation_248** • 6mo ago

For me it was a good software experience. Other than this the phone really was too disappointing especially with the performance and also the cameras (except selfie camera which was the best I've ever seen)

Camera: The telephoto lens even with it's 48mp was ok The main camera can take good shots when there is light but for night shots it was terrible terrible terrible

The videos are okay (i hate the video boost feature) why i have to wait for 4-5h to get my videos to be good.

The ultrawide was okay

And finally pleeeaaaaaaase gooooooogle fix your portrait mode (1x 2x 3x and 5x) for the love of god And the edge detection

Performance: Ok but not 1000\$ phone level.

AI: probably the best phone I've ever used i loved Gemini. Magic editor the pixel studio

The screen: it was okay. The camera cutout is too big tbh (but for that selfie camera i don't mind)

The fingerprint reader is amazingly good

for me i give the phone 7/10

**Low_Advance3064** • 6mo ago

is it really 5 hours for video boost? Damn, maybe I will switch to iPhone then....

**OzarkBeard** • 6mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

see ya

**mz_king1** **OP** • 6mo ago • Edited 6mo ago

Pixel 9

Cameras are pretty good to me. Day light photography picks up some really good shots. Although night time photography still needs improvement.

Yeah they could work on edge detection and other camera enhancements. Overall as a student it does my job pretty wel.

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**OzarkBeard** • 6mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

**...for night shots it was terrible terrible terrible...*

It should work great using Night Sight setting.

**bannana** • 6mo ago • Edited 6mo ago

I went from a 6 to a 9 also and it's def faster and the battery better but the new update that happened this week just made my 'extra dim' button completely useless and my screen is ridiculously bright even with all the settings turned down and with night and bedtime modes on where before it was so dark I would have to toggle it up even in a pitch black room with the 9 easily being the dimmest I've ever seen a phone until this week. Also I've noticed zero improvement with the finger print, it's still terrible over here.

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago • Edited 6mo ago

Pixel 9

I use an app called "twilight" which force dims the screen past the normal range.

**bannana** • 6mo ago

ya, I'm trying some 3rd party apps today since this needs to be fixed asap. I used twilight in the past though it's been some years but I feel as though this broken thing should be fixed and I shouldn't have to go back doing things like I did 10yrs ago, Google should just fix the damn thing that worked great yesterday.

**Ryano891** • 6mo ago

Nice thoughtful write up. But.....

" happy that they have added Mag safe for wireless charging to the phone. Although realistically still use Wired charging as its way faster" - what now? The Pixel 9 does not have magsafe. You can get cases with a magnet to add magnetic charging, but the phone itself definitely doesn't have it.

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

Yeah I meant the case, Not an inbuilt one mb.

**Ryano891** • 6mo ago

Ah I see. We've had those for a few years now

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**mylostzebra** • 6mo ago**d4ngerdan** • 6mo ago

I've used many phones, but the pixel phones literally are better at copy and pasting info from the screen, and being able to hand write signatures while zooming into a form. This detail is very important for me due to how I process forms for work. You would be surprised how hard it is to do on iPhones, and every android phone handles this differently.

**mz_king1** OP • 6mo ago

Pixel 9

Yeah this is an amazing feature that's pixel unique

**d4ngerdan** • 6mo ago

I've had many makes but I can't bring myself to buy a Samsung.

**OzarkBeard** • 6mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

DON'T.

Unless you like clutter, complication, two app stores and duplicate bloatware you can't uninstall or disable w/o having to use something like adb.

**d4ngerdan** • 6mo ago

Ew, sounds just like Huawei and Xiaomi, but atleast with them, I could get rid of all the crap.

**IndicationNo669** • 5mo ago

Anche io sono in felice possessore di un Pixel 9. L'unica cosa che proprio non sopporto di questo telefono è che non sono mai riuscito ad utilizzare l'uscita video tramite usb c anche cambiando due tipi di cavi con frequenze diverse tra loro. Niente appena lo collego l'unica cosa che viene riprodotta sulla TV è la foto dello sfondo della schermata iniziale. Rimane ferma lì e non succede altro. Succede anche a voi o è il mio Pixel 9 che è difettato?

**batsy---** • 4mo ago

Buy the tz spigen screen guard, it will start working smoothly

[+](#) Create

ich habe jetzt auch knapp. seit Juni mein Pixel 9. anfangs war es ganz gut, aber direkt noch einen Monat. fing schon die mikrobacks an, was mir auch aufgefallen ist. online wird das geben von Rezessionen verweigert, ohne dass man seine Daten preisgibt eine telefonnummer da gibt bei der hier wiederherstellung eines kundenkontos. das finde ich schon obiziös. ja, wie dem auch sei jetzt. nach drei Monaten fängt das Handy schon an rum zu spinnen an zu laggen. das Mikrofon versteht mich überhaupt gar nicht richtig. man muss förmlich ins Mikro reinschreien, damit es einfach steht. mich nervt es einfach nur noch. mein nächstes Handy wird auf jeden Fall kein Google Phone. mehr aus der Geschichte bin ich raus. hatte davor das Pixel 6. das war ganz in Ordnung, aber das Pixel 9. das ist so eine Mainstream Katastrophe. das ist nur darauf gedeixelt irgendwelche tausend KI Funktionen zu haben, aber richtig zur funktionieren. jetzt nach diesen vier Monaten hat es schon 4% an Akku Lebensdauer verloren. das finde ich schon heftig. dann kann man mal sehen, wie lange die Langlebigkeit bei chinesischen Produkten ist. das soll keine Wertung sein. das ist meine eigene Meinung zu einem Produkt 🙄

**techfpv5960** • 3mo ago

After being a 15 year Samsung phone user I decided to go with the Google Pixel 9, 9 months ago and so I had my phone in my pocket and as I bent down to pick something up the phone fell onto the floor and the screen cracked straight across and in 2 places covering the entire screen. The drop was no further than 2 feet. I've never had any of my Samsung screens crack, ever so I called Google and they quoted me a price of \$349.00 to replace the screen which is still in warranty so I called the supplier Xfinity and since I have an Assurant warranty they'll cover the cost but I have to drive 50 miles one way since they don't have any cell phone repair stores near me and I live near a big city. At first I was very happy with my Pixel 9 as it is very fast and has plenty of storage but this experience has left a bad taste and I won't be buying another Google Pixel phone again and they won't cover any type of screen damage, now I know why, it's because the screen is definitely unreliable and they know it. Now I'm forced to use a brand new phone with a totally cracked screen until I can take half of a day out of my life to get it fixed. I'll be going over to iPhone for the very first time in the near future to trade in this unreliable Pixel 9. Hope this review helps at least one person. 🍷